



Suttons on Mission



CHURCH PLANTING IN UTAH

Volume 2, Issue 8 - August 2026

PRAYERS ANSWERED

In our last newsletter, we asked for prayer concerning a planting partner for Andrew. With so much growth in our community group, we were worried without a partner, the church plant launch would be halted. Within a few days of sending out the July newsletter, the Lord answered our prayers for clarity, direction, and a planting partner.

Meet the Paulk Family! Ben, Nicole, and baby Hosanna moved to Utah in January of 2026. Nicole is a full-time mom to Hosanna after serving as an executive assistant at a Boston-based investment firm. Ben serves full-time as an active duty Air Force officer, though his passion for pastoral ministry led him to earn a Master of Divinity from the Southern Baptist Theological Seminary in 2025. While he has served for four years as a deacon, he has been eagerly training to serve in pastoral ministry for a decade.

After much prayer, Ben accepted the role as planting partner for Redemption Lakeside and we are thrilled to have their family join our team. Thank you for praying with us concerning this crucial part of the church planting process.



MOVING INTO THE NEXT PLANTING PHASE

Now that Ben has joined the planting team, we can start looking forward to the next planting phase for Redemption Lakeside. Due to the growth of our community group, it is apparent the time has come to move ahead with Phase 2 of planting - developing a core team. In order to accomplish this, we will begin meeting each Sunday night with those interested in Redemption Lakeside membership. These meetings will likely begin in late fall.

August Ministry Calendar



- Redemption Leadership School - Every Monday night 6:15-8:15 beginning Aug. 10th
- Young Adult Pickleball Outreach - Every Wednesday night @ 6:30pm
- Syracuse Community Group - Every Thursday night @ 6:30pm
- Andrew's D-Group - meets weekly at various times
- Rachael's D-Group - Saturday mornings
- Redemption Bear River Launch - Sunday, August 30

- Another exciting update is that we have established an official launch date! Redemption Lakeside is set to launch on Easter Sunday, March 28, 2027. In preparation for the launch, we invite you to join us in praying for a location where our church can meet. There are several venues and office spaces in the area, but we are praying for one that will meet our needs both in size and price. As our launch date approaches, we will be sending out an Amazon wishlist for anyone who wishes to donate furniture and/or supplies to the church plant.



Not only are we excited about the upcoming church launch, but the month of July saw a record attendance in our community group. One Thursday evening, we welcomed 34 people into our group! We are quickly running out of space in the basement to accommodate everyone...what a joyous problem to have! Our hope is that the bulk of this group will join our core team as we move toward the launch date. Until then, we will continue adding additional folding chairs to welcome more in.

SERVICE MISSION DOWN SOUTH

Last month, our family joined a mission team sent to serve with Community of Grace Church in Colorado City, AZ. Surrounded by beautiful red rocks, this city is best known as the historic headquarters of the Fundamentalist Church of Latter Day Saints (FLDS); a polygamist sect. While the Lord is doing a work in this community, the FLDS still have quite a stronghold in the city.

Families who leave the FLDS find themselves without the support of their community, completely cut off from friends and family. Furthermore, of the 8,000 people living in Colorado City, 80% of them are 18 and younger. When you consider the ramifications of that statistic mixed with the fear of excommunication, you quickly realize the need. We were only there for a day and a half, but in that time, we were able to help support a new church plant as they ministered to their hurting community. Hopefully we will get to return next year, but until then we pray God's hand of protection over Community of Grace and Colorado City.



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suttonsonmission



suttonsonmission@gmail.com



(931)216-6625

GOODBYE SUMMER

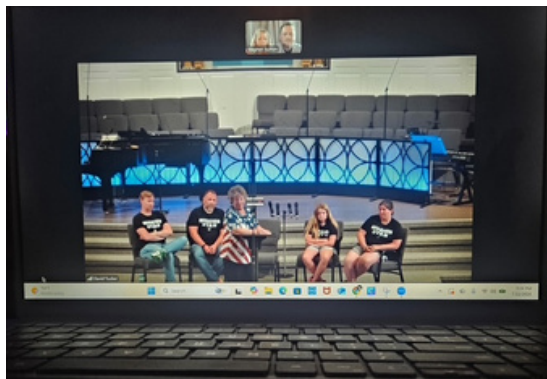
SUMMER MISSIONS WRAP UP

Weeks after the KY mission team returned home, the Redemption Family of Churches welcomed another large group of mission teams as a part of our summer "Mission Utah" program. Our family plugged in wherever we could to help equip these teams for ministry during a celebration known as Pioneer Week; a statewide celebration centered on Pioneer Day (July 24) that commemorates the arrival of the first Mormon pioneers led by Brigham Young into the Salt Lake Valley in 1847. To put this into perspective, this celebration is considered a second Independence Day and crowds often surpass 4th of July crowds.

To prepare for the Pioneer day parade, we delivered 6,000 lbs of water bottles for Redemption North Davis to pass out. Our family decked out the Jeep and walked in the parade, passing out chapstick and other Redemption trinkets. Our goal in participating in this event is to make our presence known in the community and to offer an alternative to the cultural religious norms of our area. At four different checkpoints in the parade, an announcer would introduce our "float" to the crowd as an evangelical church who teaches hope from a biblical perspective. It was reported that 30,000+ people came to watch the parade and since then, we have already seen a rise in our attendance at Redemption Ogden likely due to Pioneer Week events.

Wrapping up the summer missions season, we had the opportunity to debrief with our Second Baptist team over zoom; answering questions about the work in Utah and sharing "God stories" with the team. Not only was it good to see members of the team again (virtually) but, it was a blessing to hear their perspective about what God is doing in Utah.

The final missions event was a worship night at Redemption Ogden. All the Mission Utah teams gathered for the last time to debrief and learn more about furthering the work in Utah. Toward the end of the service, all RFC planting pastors, including Andrew and Ben, were brought forward to be prayed over. This was a humbling moment for the pastors and perfect way to close out the summer missions season.



Praises & Prayer Requests



- Pray for Andrea, Hannah and Lilly as they begin a new school year.
- Praise for the Paulks joining our planting team. Pray for their family as they adjust to this new role.
- Pray that we are able to find a meeting place for Redemption Lakeside, as well as the financial support to sustain it.
- Continue praying for the Syracuse community group.
- Pray for the August 30th launch of Redemption Bear River! Click [here](#) for more information about Redemption Bear River.

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